



SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

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Topic:		Identifying Fatigue			

This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.

Fatigue is the condition of being physically or mentally tired or exhausted. Extreme fatigue can lead to uncontrolled and involuntary shutdown of the brain. Here are some things to look for in your colleagues to help identify fatigue.

Everyone needs your help, because in most cases, people who are under significant fatigue cannot identify themselves.

These include:

- Their job performance slows.
- Their job quality is reduced.
- They cannot recall their last thought, conversation, or what they did a moment ago.
- They have trouble solving problems.
- They make errors.
- They have a near-miss accident.
- They have trouble focusing.
- The head droops.
- They cannot stop yawning.

When you are fatigued **you will make errors in judgment.**

Your mind or eyes can be off the task in hand and you can make a critical error.

Remember that employees have the following responsibilities under The Health and Safety at Work Act 1974 Section 7:

- To take reasonable care for the health and safety of themselves and others who may be affected by their acts or omissions at work.
- To co-operate with their employer or any other person, so far as is necessary, to enable their employer or other person to perform or comply with any requirement or duty imposed under a relevant statutory provision.

Discussion Points

Have you noticed anyone who might be suffering fatigue today?

Has anyone got some tips regards fatigue?